CiteAlpha GCI: Consolidated Strategy Document

Guidance Credibility Index (GCI): theory, product architecture, go-to-market, valuation and exit. Master reference for internal discussion and product development, consolidated from the Gemini discussion, the CiteAlpha white papers, the technical and terminal specifications and the founder briefs, with an evaluative layer added. Where the source conversation made unsupported claims, this document flags them rather than carrying them forward.

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1. Executive Summary and Reading Guide

The source documents describe two different products under the same name, GCI. The 16 October white paper defines a filing-linked, descriptive record of guidance delivery (Bias, Dispersion, Path). The 10 October white paper v3.40, the technical specification and the briefs define a single 0 to 100 "topological" score built from asymmetric loss, cyclotomic phase, p-adic distance and LLM tone analysis. This master reference keeps the first as the foundation (Layer 1), treats the second as a set of derived candidates (Layer 3) that must earn their place by evidence, and records every conflict with a proposed resolution.

1.1 Source inventory

Document	Date	What it contributes	Evidence status
Measuring Management Guidance Credibility, white paper v0.1	16 Oct 2026	Locked original guidance, Bias / Dispersion / Path, Revision Lift, India rules, validation plan	Draft for review; references cited from memory; no results yet
GCI white paper v3.40	10 Oct 2026	Asymmetric loss, cyclotomic phase, p-adic metric, q-GCI, multi-metric tensor, backtest claims	Backtest figures cannot be reproduced from the documents
GCI Technical Implementation Specification	10 Oct 2026	Pipeline design, per-metric loss parameters, thresholds, API endpoints	Parameters asserted, not estimated

Document	Date	What it contributes	Evidence status
Executive Methodology Guide (founder's brief)	10 Oct 2026	Pitch narrative, four pillars, exit blueprint	Marketing language; contains motive claims
Universal GCI Strategy Blueprint (.docx)	10 Oct 2026	Dual-hub go-to-market, acquirer table, ARR target	Valuation arithmetic does not reconcile
Terminal Onboarding Specification and Comprehensive Specification	10 Oct 2026	Bloomberg, FactSet, LSEG requirements and phases	Depends on partner programmes; unresolved citation placeholders
Gemini discussion	Undated	Valuation, acquirers, multi-metric and q-GCI ideas, Mumbai and Singapore plan	Conversational; corrections in Section 9

1.2 Headline findings

1. **The conceptual core is strong.** Locked original guidance, three independent dimensions, Revision Lift, filing-linked evidence per instance and intent-neutral labels give a framework that can be explained to a board and audited line by line.
2. **The topological scalar is a candidate, not a foundation.** The documents never specify how its components combine into the 0 to 100 score, several constructs are internally inconsistent (Section 2.7), and the +8.4% alpha claim has no data, code or universe definition behind it. The later-dated v0.1 paper lists the same kind of validation as future work.
3. **The documents disagree on five points:** output form, tone analysis, motive language, treatment of revisions, and normalization (Section 3.1).
4. **The commercial numbers do not reconcile.** 50 to 80 clients at $300k to $500k ACV gives $15M to $40M ARR, not $75.2M. Reaching $75.2M at those prices takes roughly 150 to 250 clients (Section 6).
5. **"World's first" has to be stated narrowly.** The phenomenon is well studied. The defensible novelty is a packaged, standardized, auditable record (Section 2.4).

1.3 Decisions needed from the document owners

ID	Decision	Recommendation	Criticality
D1	Architecture	Adopt the layered framework; the descriptive core is v1	Critical

ID	Decision	Recommendation	Criticality
D2	Language	Retire motive words ("sandbagging", "deceiving", "gaming") from product, decks and marketing; use "conservative-guidance signature"	Critical
D3	q-GCI	Ship as a separate opt-in module, starting with a directional-claim ledger; do not blend into the core	High
D4	Evidence	Quarantine external use of the 15-year backtest figures until reproduced or retired	Critical
D5	Scope	India first (NIFTY 500), then STI; US, Europe and Japan after validation	High
D6	Commercial model	Rebuild ARR bottom-up: logos x ACV x conversion x sales cycle	High
D7	Naming	Fix one glossary (Section 13) and stop using GCI, EGIS and TCI interchangeably	Medium

1.4 How to read this document

Product and engineering: Sections 2, 3 and 12. Strategy, fundraising and partnerships: Sections 4 to 11. Items marked "unverified" must not appear in external material until the validation steps in Section 3.3 are done.

2. Conceptual Foundation

Guidance credibility is a behavioural record, not an opinion. This section fixes the definition, the vocabulary and the rules that every later construct has to respect.

2.1 What guidance credibility is

Definition. Management guidance credibility is the demonstrated reliability with which a company's forward statements about measurable outcomes are later borne out, measured from the public record as it stood when each statement was made.

Operating interpretation (a hypothesis to validate). A credibility profile is a calibration function for the company's next guidance. Given a new band, the profile says where the result is likely to land relative to it (Bias), how wide the real uncertainty is (Dispersion), and how likely the band is to be revised before results (Path). This is what an analyst or risk desk would actually use, and it is testable: a profile estimated on past instances should predict the position of the next outcome relative to its guidance.

Three distinctions keep the concept clean:

- **Credibility is not accuracy.** Accuracy asks how close a result is. Credibility asks whether the pattern is reliable and interpretable. A company that beats its band by a similar margin every quarter is inaccurate but predictable.
- **Credibility is not governance quality.** Governance indices rate structures and policies. The profile records the outcomes of promises.
- **Credibility is not intent.** The framework describes behaviour and never infers motive.

Dimension	Question	Measure	Layer
Bias	Where do results land relative to the original band?	Bias Index (BI), mean surprise	Core
Precision	How tightly does management hit its guidance?	Robust dispersion (D)	Core
Path	How often is guidance revised before results, and which way?	Walk-down and walk-up shares, Revision Lift, depth, timing	Core
Participation	Does the company keep guiding?	Continuity ratio, withdrawn count	Core
Cross-metric coherence	Do outcomes on different metrics agree in the same period?	Divergence pattern flag (proposed)	Derived
Timeliness	Does disclosure cadence drift?	Days to disclosure vs own history and statutory deadline (proposed)	Derived
Narrative consistency	Does language line up with outcomes?	Directional-claim ledger; tone signals	Derived, experimental

2.2 Behavioural taxonomy

Each behaviour has an observable definition, a place where it is measured, and a neutral label. Product copy uses the label, never a motive word.

Behaviour	Observable definition	Measured by	Neutral label
Calibrated delivery	Results mostly inside the original band	BI between -20 and +20	Calibrated
Conservative guidance (often called sandbagging)	Results repeatedly above the original band by a material margin	BI at least +20, median overshoot at least 0.5, 60% of latest 8 Above	Conservative-guidance signature (silent or raise-and-beat form)
Over-promising	Results below the original band	BI at most -20	Over-promising
Walk-down	Unfavourable revision before results	Net revision R at most -0.5 half-widths; share at least 30%	Walk-down-prone; signature if Revision Lift at least +30
Walk-up	Favourable revision before results	R at least +0.5; share at least 30%	Walk-up-prone
Imprecision	Wide scatter of surprises	Robust D above threshold	Variable
Withdrawal or silence	Guidance withdrawn or not re-issued after a miss	Counts and continuity ratio	Counted, not scored
Guidance arbitrage	One metric met while another is missed in the same period	Cross-metric pattern (proposed)	Derived layer
Narrative drift	Language and outcomes diverge	Claim ledger, tone signals	Experimental

Why a reported beat is ambiguous. Three managements can all beat their final guidance: one that guided sensibly, one that guided low, and one that guided high, cut the target and then beat the lower number. The framework separates them: calibration appears in Bias, low original guidance in the conservative-guidance signature, and the cut in Path and Revision Lift.

2.3 Design axioms

ID	Axiom	Rule	Consequence for the product
A1	Original guidance is locked	Each instance is scored against the first guidance issued for the period, from a dated filing	A walk-down followed by a beat of the lowered number is not a beat
A2	Every input is cited	Guidance, revisions and actuals link to filing, page and paragraph; unsourced items are excluded and logged	The audit trail is the product
A3	Descriptive, not evaluative	Counts, percentages and neutral labels; no ranking, no Buy, Hold or Sell	Stays a record and limits rating-style liability
A4	Independent dimensions	Bias, Dispersion and Path are measured separately	No behaviour hides inside another
A5	Sample size is visible	Short records are labelled Insufficient record	No false precision
A6	Point-in-time	Every input carries the time it became public; no look-ahead	Backtests and audits are credible
A7	No double penalty, no hidden penalty	A walk-down is penalized once, through the locked original; Path and Revision Lift are descriptive; exclusions stay visible	Transparent arithmetic
A8	Intent-neutral	Patterns are described, never motives	Wording rules for product, decks and marketing

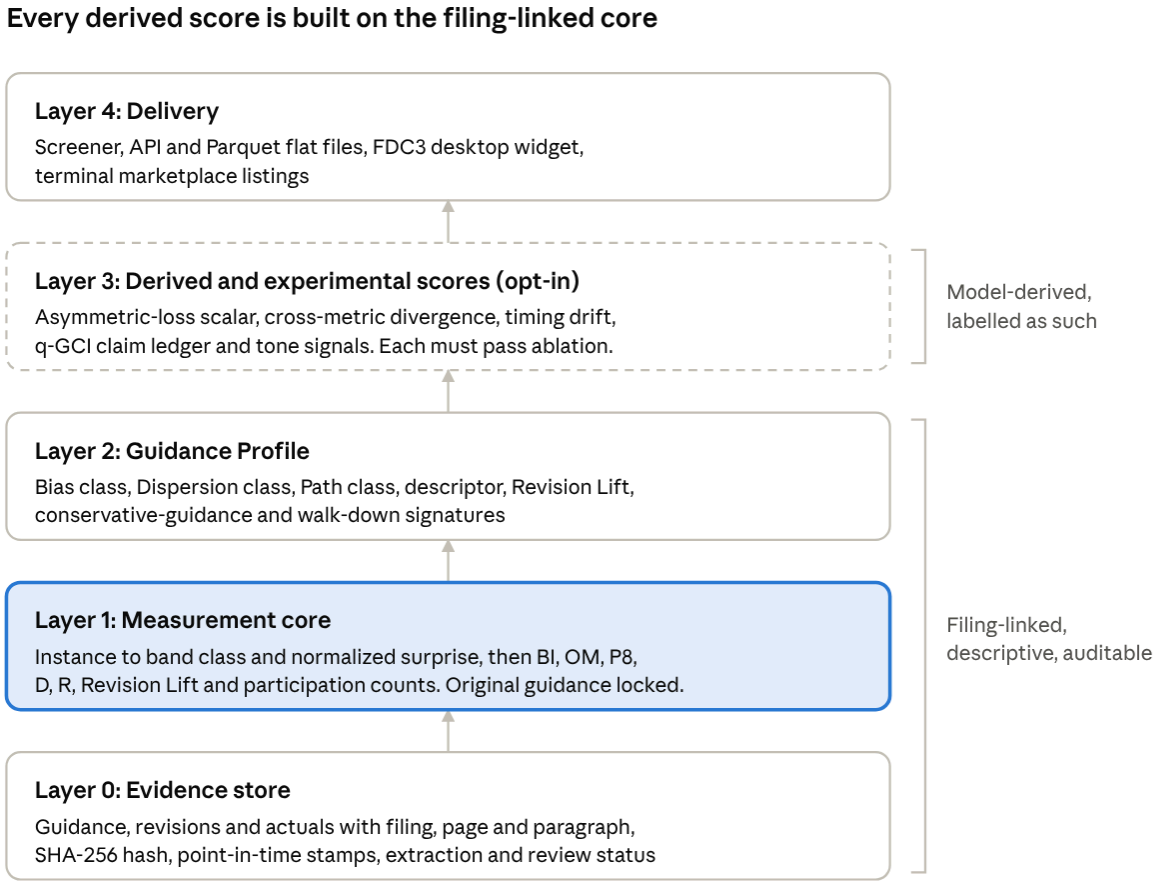
2.4 What is distinctive, and what is not

The brief for this master document asks for conceptual clarity that the market has not seen. The honest position is that the phenomenon is old and the packaging is new. The wording below is what the team can defend today.

Claim	Assessment	Wording to use
Management forecast accuracy, bias and walk-down behaviour are studied	Established academic literature (Section 14, to verify)	Cite as foundations, not as CiteAlpha discoveries
Terminals already show guidance and compare it with consensus or actuals	Likely true; not verified vendor by vendor	"To our knowledge", and only after the landscape check below
Governance and ESG indices rate structures and policies	True in general; an outcome-based promise-keeping record is a different object	Position as a complement
The combination of locked original, three independent dimensions, Revision Lift, filing-linked evidence per instance, neutral labels and India-specific rules	Plausibly novel as a standardized, auditable product; unverified	"A standardized, point-in-time, filing-linked record of guidance delivery"
"World's first", "no other provider", "universal truth engine", "monopoly"	Not supportable	Retire

Landscape check (to complete before any external novelty claim). For each of Bloomberg, FactSet, LSEG, S&P Capital IQ and the main academic datasets, open the vendor documentation and record whether it offers: original vs revised guidance history; a standardized delivery score; point-in-time stamping; filing-level evidence links; Indian coverage; and revision-behaviour measures. Cite every page opened.

2.5 Layered Framework



layered framework · 5 layers, evidence to delivery

Each layer is computed only from the layer beneath it. Layers 0 to 2 are filing-linked and auditable line by line; Layer 3 is model-derived, shown separately, and admitted only when an ablation test shows it adds something a simple baseline does not.

2.6 Measurement Core (Layer 1)

Layer 1 turns every guidance instance into a band class and a normalized surprise; everything else is counting and medians over those. The definitions below come from the v0.1 white paper, with the gaps found in it flagged in the last table of this section.

Instance and fields. One instance is one company, one metric and one period. Only quantitative, period-bound guidance with an actual reported on the same basis is eligible; ineligible instances stay visible with an exclusion reason. Point guidance is converted to a narrow band using a 1% tolerance, and the band width is floored so that very narrow ranges do not exaggerate small misses.

Field	Meaning
L0, H0	Original guided low and high
M0, W0	Original midpoint and half-width
Revisions	Dated revised ranges, each linked to its filing
A	First reported actual for the period
Basis	Currency basis, standalone or consolidated, adjusted or reported
Direction (sigma)	+1 where higher is better, -1 where lower is better

Normalized surprise. Positive means better than guided. The floor is 1% of the midpoint for levels and 0.5 percentage points for rates.

$$s^* = \sigma \cdot \frac{A - M_0}{W_0^*}, \qquad W_0^* = \max(W_0,\ \text{floor})$$

Each instance is also classed Above band, Within band or Below band against the original band in the favourable direction.

Bias, overshoot and persistence. BI is built from plain counts so that it can be explained to a board without a formula.

$$BI = 100 \times (\text{share Above} - \text{share Below})$$

$$O_i = \frac{\max\big(0,\ \sigma(A_i - H_0)\big)}{W_0^*}$$

$$OM = \text{median}\{O_i : i \text{ Above}\}, \qquad P_8 = \frac{\#\text{Above in latest } 8}{8}$$

Dispersion. A robust standard deviation of the normalized surprise, so one windfall does not dominate.

$$D = 1.4826 \cdot \text{median}\left(\left|s_i^* - \text{median}(s^*)\right|\right)$$

Path and Revision Lift. R is the net revision of one instance in original half-widths; Revision Lift compares the record against final guidance with the record against original guidance.

$$R = \sigma \cdot \frac{M_{final} - M_0}{W_0^*}, \qquad RL = BI_{final} - BI_{original}$$

Measure	Rule	Class or output
Bias Index	Share Above minus share Below, times 100	Under-promising at BI +20 or more; Calibrated between; Over-promising at -20 or less
Conservative-guidance signature	Bias class Under-promising, and OM at least 0.5, and P8 at least 60%, with at least N_min closed instances	Silent form (Path Stable, Revision Lift near zero) or raise-and-beat form (Walk-up-prone, Revision Lift -30 or lower)
Dispersion D	Robust SD of s*; one-sided guidance excluded	Precise at or below a fixed published threshold, else Variable
Path	Walk-down if R at most -0.5; walk-up if R at least +0.5; shares over closed instances	Rules applied in order: both shares at least 30% gives Mixed; walk-down at least 30% gives Walk-down-prone; walk-up at least 30% gives Walk-up-prone; else Stable
Walk-down signature	Walk-down-prone with Revision Lift at least +30	The record looks stronger against final guidance than against original
Depth and timing	Mean size of walk-downs in original half-widths; share issued in the second half of the guided period	Display only

Measure	Rule	Class or output
Participation	Withdrawn count; continuity = periods guided over periods expected	Counted and displayed, never scored as a miss
Minimum record	N_min = 6 closed instances	Otherwise Insufficient record

Profiles. Bias (3 classes) and Dispersion (2 classes) give six mutually exclusive profiles; Path adds one of four classes, so every company with enough history gets exactly one descriptor, for example "Tightly calibrated, Walk-down-prone, Revision Lift +50".

	Precise	Variable
Under-promising	Consistently conservative	Conservative, uneven
Calibrated	Tightly calibrated	Calibrated on average, uneven
Over-promising	Consistently short of guidance	Short of guidance, uneven

What the conservative-guidance signature is not. A walk-down followed by a beat of the lowered number does not trigger it; that instance scores Within or Below against the original and shows up under Path. A company whose results land Within the band does not trigger it however often it hits. Conservative guidance can be a reasonable response to genuine uncertainty, so sector context is shown and intent is never inferred.

Rules for India and general cases.

Case	Rule
Constant-currency guidance, reported-currency results	Score only on the basis guided; if the actual is not disclosed on that basis, exclude and log
Directional guidance (double-digit growth, mid-teens margin)	Map to a one-sided bound using a published dictionary of terms
Fiscal year April to March	Quarters labelled Q1 to Q4 of the fiscal year
Standalone vs consolidated	Store both; score on the basis guided
Restated actuals	Score on the first reported actual; show the restated value alongside
Mergers, demergers, one-offs	Flag, annotate, provide a sensitivity view; never remove from the main record

Case	Rule
Call vs filing	Prefer the formal filing; keep the call transcript as supporting evidence

Golden test cases for engineering. Both come from the v0.1 paper and should be encoded as unit tests. Dispersion is assumed Precise in both.

Case A, walk-down-prone company (8 closed instances):

#	Vs original band	Revision	Vs final band
1	Above	None	Above
2	Within	None	Within
3	Within	Walk-down	Above
4	Below	Walk-down	Within
5	Within	Walk-down	Above
6	Above	None	Above
7	Within	None	Within
8	Below	Walk-down	Within

Expected: BI 0 (Calibrated); BI_final +50; Revision Lift +50; walk-down share 50% (Walk-down-prone); walk-down signature present; descriptor "Tightly calibrated, Walk-down-prone, Revision Lift +50".

Case B, persistent under-promising (8 closed instances, no revisions):

#	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Vs original band	Above	Above	Above	Above	Within	Above	Above	Above
Overshoot O	0.8	1.2	0.5	1.0	0	0.9	1.4	0.7

Expected: BI 87.5 (Under-promising); OM 0.9; P8 87.5%; Path Stable with Revision Lift 0, so the silent form; descriptor "Consistently conservative, Stable path, with the conservative-guidance signature".

Open design questions in the core. These are gaps in v0.1 that engineering will hit on day one.

Question	Why it matters	Proposed handling	Criticality
One-sided guidance ("at least 15%") has no band	W0 and s* are undefined and "Within" cannot occur, so BI is degenerate	Report a separate bound-hit rate; exclude from BI and D until defined	High
Instance independence	Several metrics for one company and period are correlated yet counted as separate instances	Report effective sample size; test per-metric vs per-period aggregation	High
Favourable edge for lower-is-better metrics	v0.1 writes H0 as the upper edge; for cost metrics the favourable edge is the low edge	Define H0 as the favourable edge of the band	Medium
Recency half-life of 8 quarters	Listed as a parameter but used in no definition	Weight instances with it, or drop it	Medium
Overlapping horizons	Quarterly and annual guidance for the same year overlap	Tag horizon and compute per horizon	Medium
Band-width effects	Wide bands make Calibrated easier to reach	Display band width; test results stratified by width	Medium

2.7 Derived and Experimental Constructs (Layer 3)

Each construct in the v3.40 white paper asks a real question, but none is ready to be a foundation. The table is the verdict; the notes under it give the reasoning and the formulas, so each can be tested.

Construct	Valid intent	Principal issues	Recommendation	Criticality
Asymmetric loss L(delta)	Misses cost more than beats	Normalized by guided value, not band; alpha and beta asserted; wording conflict on beats; MAE argument misstated	Keep as candidate; estimate alpha and beta from price reactions; use band-normalized s*	High
Multi-metric vector and EGIS	Catch one metric hit by missing another	EGIS factor can go negative; gradient-based, so same-period divergence is missed; re-penalizes misses	Keep the vector; replace the multiplicative penalty with an explicit divergence flag	High
Cyclotomic phase	Detect drift in reporting rhythm	Roots of unity defined but unused; performance and timing mixed in one sum; spec and paper disagree	Replace with a direct Timeliness measure; keep only if it wins an ablation	Medium
p-adic hierarchy	Quarters nest in years; mid-period revisions matter	p = 4 is not prime; indexing undefined and, on quarter indices, gives the opposite of the claim; direction-blind	Retire as a score; use Path depth and timing plus a hierarchy-consistency check	Medium
q-GCI	Cover issuers that guide in words; early warning	No ground truth; lexicon vs LLM ambiguity; hedging is not a credibility failure	Split into a claim ledger (v1) and tone signals (v2), as a separate module	High

Construct	Valid intent	Principal issues	Recommendation	Criticality
Regime harmonization	Compare across disclosure regimes	Per-regime z-scores erase real differences; adjustment values unsourced	Show regime context beside unitless core measures	Medium
Single 0 to 100 score	A simple headline	Aggregation of the components is never specified	Specify fully or drop; the profile stays the primary output	Critical

Asymmetric loss. Defined on the relative deviation from the guided value.

$$\delta = \frac{R_{actual} - R_{guided}}{|R_{guided}|}$$

$$L(\delta) = \begin{cases} e^{\alpha|\delta|} - 1 & \delta < 0 \\ \beta \ln(1+\delta) & \delta \geq 0 \end{cases}$$

The paper sets alpha = 1.8 and beta = 0.45. The specification gives per-metric values: Revenue 1.6 and 0.50, EBITDA margin 2.2 and 0.35, Volume 1.7 and 0.45, Net profit or EPS 2.0 and 0.40, CapEx or ROIC 1.5 and 0.60. None is derived from data, and the specification does not say where the 1.8 and 0.45 defaults apply.

- **Two different asymmetries are in play.** Market-consequence asymmetry (a miss costs more than a beat) is an empirical claim about price reactions and belongs to the loss curve. Behavioural asymmetry (under-promising and over-promising are different behaviours) belongs to the classes in Layer 1. Keep them apart.
- **Normalization.** Dividing by the guided value breaks for rates and margins (a 1 point miss is 5% of a 20% margin but 50% of a 2% margin) and for near-zero or negative bases such as EPS. The core uses the original half-width with a floor.
- **Beats.** A beat carries a positive loss that grows with size, so a large beat lowers the score. The briefs call this "capping the reward". Decide once whether a beat is a credibility cost (a predictability view) or neutral, and write it down.

- **Proposition 2.2 is misstated.** MAE is minimized by unbiased guidance, so it does not reward downward bias; it is sign-blind. The valid result is the newsvendor one: if a miss costs k times a beat, the executive's optimal target sits below the mean.

$$g^* = \mu + \sigma\,\Phi^{-1}\left(\frac{1}{1+k}\right) < \mu \qquad (k > 1)$$

That result motivates measuring Bias separately; it is not a defect of MAE.

- **Calibration.** Estimate alpha and beta per metric from the response of abnormal returns to s*, split by sign. Asymmetric market response is discussed in the literature (Skinner and Sloan, 2002, to verify).

Multi-metric vector and EGIS.

$$EGIS_t = \Big(\sum_m w_m\, GCI_{m,t}\Big) \cdot \prod_{j \neq k} \Big(1 - \lambda \max(0,\ \nabla GCI_{j,t} - \nabla GCI_{k,t})\Big), \quad \lambda = 0.15$$

- On 0 to 100 scores a 10 point gradient gap gives lambda times gap of 1.5, so a factor turns negative; with five metrics the product runs over 20 ordered pairs, so penalties compound.
- It uses quarter-on-quarter score changes, so the paper's own example (Revenue 90 against Margin 35 in the same period) is not caught unless scores moved.
- It penalizes misses a second time after each metric already scored them, which breaks axiom A7.
- **Replacement:** a categorical divergence flag, for example Revenue Above and Margin or Net Below in the same period, in at least k of the latest N periods. It is auditable, testable and needs no tuning constant.

Cyclotomic phase.

$$Z_t = \sum_{k=1}^{K} w_k \big(1 - L(\delta_{t-k})\big) e^{-i\omega_0 (t - t_k)}, \qquad \theta_t = \arg Z_t$$

$$\Phi = e^{\gamma\,|1 - \cos(\theta_t - \theta_0)|} - 1, \qquad \gamma = 2.5$$

- Roots of unity for N = 4 or 2 are defined, but Z_t uses a calendar-day phase with omega_0 = 2 pi / 365, so they are never used.
- The weight 1 - L puts performance into the phase, so outcomes can move the angle with no change in timing, and 1 - L goes negative for large misses.
- The paper applies a smooth penalty; the specification applies a flat 15 point drop beyond 0.35 radians, which is about 20 calendar days on a 365-day circle.
- **Replacement:** a Timeliness measure: days from period end to disclosure against the company's own median and against the statutory limit, plus the cadence of guidance issuance. Keep the cyclotomic form only if it beats this in ablation.

p-adic hierarchy.

$$d_4(x, y) = 4^{-v_4(x-y)} \quad (x \neq y)$$

$$d_4(x, z) \leq \max\big(d_4(x, y),\ d_4(y, z)\big)$$

- 4 is not prime. The construction is a valid ultrametric (same topology as the 2-adic one), so "p-adic with p = 4" should be renamed.
- The claim that sequential quarterly reports sit at distance 0.25 and a mid-quarter revision at 1.0 depends on an index that is never defined. With quarters indexed 1, 2, 3, adjacent quarters differ by 1, so v4 = 0 and the distance is 1.0 (the maximum), while quarters a year apart differ by 4 and sit at 0.25.
- The distance is symmetric and direction-blind, so a timely upward revision and an emergency walk-down cost the same, which penalizes timely disclosure.
- **Replacement:** Path depth and timing already describe revisions. Add a hierarchy-consistency check: does annual guidance reconcile with cumulative quarterly delivery? Keep the ultrametric as a research note.

q-GCI.

$$H_{score} = \frac{\sum_i w_i \, \mathbf{1}[\text{token}_i \in K_{amb}]}{\sum_i w_i \, \mathbf{1}[\text{token}_i \in K_{amb}] + \sum_j v_j \, \mathbf{1}[\text{token}_j \in K_{ass}]}$$

$$\Delta N_t = \max(0,\ S_{transcript,t} - O_{actual,t+1})$$

- The formula counts lexicon tokens while the text describes fine-tuned transformer embeddings; the word lists, weights, S and O are undefined.

- A qualitative statement has no objective hit or miss, so there is no ground truth to test against.
- Hedging is not itself a credibility failure; honest caution is hedged.
- Axiom A3 excludes tone. Blending tone into one index mixes two evidence classes.
- "Zero-hallucination" cannot be guaranteed for an LLM pipeline.
- **q-GCI v1, the directional-claim ledger:** extract testable directional claims ("margins to expand in H2") with filing and sentence reference, lock the original, and score the outcome against later reported metrics with the same Above, Within, Below logic. It stays filing-linked and outcome-checkable.
- **q-GCI v2, narrative signals:** tone and hedging, shown separately and labelled model-derived, benchmarked against a finance-specific lexicon (Loughran and McDonald, 2011, to verify), with human sampling and no blending into the core.
- **Wording:** replace "zero-hallucination" with "source-linked extraction: every score traces to cited sentences, with verification status".

Regime harmonization.

$$GCI_{harm} = \frac{EGIS_t - \mu_{regime}}{\sigma_{regime}} \cdot \sigma_{global} + \mu_{global}$$

Z-scoring inside each regime gives every regime the same mean and spread by construction. The output answers "where does this company sit within its regime" and cannot answer "are Indian companies more reliable than US ones". The regime adjustments in the paper (SEC +0.25, ESMA/MAR -0.10, SEBI LODR +0.05, J-GAAP/TSE +0.30) have no source. State which question each output answers, and show regime context beside the unitless core measures.

The single score. v3.40 goes from EGIS (Eq. 12) straight to harmonization (Eq. 13). Nothing specifies how the asymmetric loss, phase penalty, ultrametric distance, hedging score and narrative divergence combine into one bounded number, or how a loss that runs from zero to infinity maps to a 0 to 100 credibility score. If a scalar is kept, specify a monotone, bounded transform of a weighted sum of component losses, with weights estimated, documented and versioned, and the profile always shown beside it. The word "topological" appears as a label, but only an ultrametric is used; avoid it until it is defined.

3. Reconciling the Source Documents

The documents conflict on eleven points; each has a proposed resolution that follows the layered framework. Where the descriptive framework and the topological documents disagree, the proposal favours whichever is auditable today and moves the other to Layer 3 until it is tested.

3.1 Conflicts register

#	Topic	Descriptive framework (v0.1)	Topological documents (v3.40, specification, briefs)	Proposed resolution
1	Output form	Profile of three independent dimensions and a descriptor; no ranking	One 0 to 100 score, harmonized, with composite EGIS and TCI	Profile is primary; the scalar is optional, only if fully specified and validated
2	Tone and sentiment	Excluded: no sentiment, no tone, no opinion	Hedging score and narrative divergence are central and blended into TCI	Separate opt-in module; claim ledger first; never blended into the core
3	Motive	Describes patterns, not intent; neutral label	"Sandbagging" to trigger executive bonuses, "deceiving passive investors", "truth engine"	Neutral wording only (D2); motive claims about named listed companies carry legal and reputational risk
4	Revisions	Path, Revision Lift, no double penalty; revisions may answer real shocks; sensitivity view	p-adic distance penalizes mid-period revisions severely	Use Path and Revision Lift; retire the p-adic score
5	Normalization	Original half-width with a floor	Percent of guided value	Half-width with a floor
6	Asymmetry	Behavioural classes (Under-promising vs Over-promising)	Market-loss curve with alpha and beta	Keep both with separate roles (Section 2.7)

#	Topic	Descriptive framework (v0.1)	Topological documents (v3.40, specification, briefs)	Proposed resolution
7	Validation status	Draft; validation plan covers back-fill, stability, sensitivity, extraction and event study; references from memory	"Empirically proven" +8.4% alpha; 15-year backtest on 3,500 equities	Owner to confirm status. If a backtest exists, document data, code and universe; if not, retire the figures (D4)
8	Coverage and scope	Companies that guide quantitatively; Indian listed companies	"No equity on earth is left un-scorable"; US, Europe, Japan, APAC	State coverage as a measured percentage; India first (D5)
9	Evidence language	Every number links to filing, page and paragraph, with verification status	"Zero-hallucination"	Use "source-linked, verified extraction"
10	Terminology	Bias, Dispersion, Path, descriptor	GCI used for the scalar, each metric score and the framework; EGIS; TCI	One name per object (Section 13)
11	Scale of ambition	Describes behaviour; "not investment advice"	"Universal standard", "monopoly", "unicorn"	Keep ambition in strategy sections; keep product and methodology language factual

3.2 Claims register



Status is judged from the documents provided. "Unverified" means the documents give no data, code or source, not that the claim is false.

Claim	Source	Status	Action
+8.4% net annualized orthogonal alpha (t = 4.12); 15-year backtest on 3,500 equities; 3.8x fewer gap-downs	v3.40	Unverified. No data, code, universe, cost assumptions or guidance-data provenance; the later v0.1 paper schedules back-fill and an event study as future work	Reproduce or retire; do not use externally
Q1 16.8% vs Q5 4.2%; long-short Sharpe 2.14; max drawdown -8.1%	v3.40	Unusually strong for a guidance signal; needs checks for look-ahead, survivorship, point-in-time guidance availability, costs and capacity	Independent review
Correlation with Barra factors below 0.12	v3.40	Needs licensed Barra factor returns; source not stated	Document data and licence
Over 50% of global issuers publish qualitative outlooks	v3.40, briefs	Unsourced	Source it or remove it
Regime adjustments +0.25, -0.10, +0.05, +0.30	v3.40 Table 1	Unsourced	Derive empirically or remove
Per-metric alpha and beta	Specification	Asserted	Estimate (Section 3.3)
"First quantitative, multi-factor framework"; "no other provider offers"	v3.40, Gemini	Priority claim not verified	Landscape check (Section 2.4)
350,000+ subscribers; $32,000+ per seat per year	Specifications, briefs	Widely quoted; the comprehensive specification still carries "[cite: 7]" and "[cite: 8]" placeholders	Verify and cite properly

Claim	Source	Status	Action
"GCI <GO>" mnemonic, B-PIPE as a publishing route, PORT factor ingestion	Specifications	Mnemonics, entitlements and factor ingestion are controlled by Bloomberg; B-PIPE is a Bloomberg data feed, not an obvious third-party publishing channel	Verify against Bloomberg's current partner and developer programmes
"SOC 2 Type II certified"	Onboarding specification	Stated as present, while the comprehensive specification lists it as a prerequisite due in months 7 to 12	Clarify whether it means the cloud provider's attestation or CiteAlpha's own
99.99% uptime; sub-100 ms latency (sub-150 ms for FactSet)	Comprehensive specification	Enterprise targets, not prototype capabilities	Tiered SLAs by stage
$75.2M ARR from 50 to 80 clients at $300k to $500k	Brief, Blueprint	50 x $300k = $15M and 80 x $500k = $40M	Rebuild the model (Section 6)
$75.2M ARR in 24 to 36 months; Bloomberg go-live in months 7 to 12	Blueprint, specifications	Terminal go-live depends on partner programmes; the ARR path is not defined	Re-plan with evidence gates (Section 7)

3.3 Validation Plan and Parameter Register

Validation comes before outreach: nothing in Sections 4 to 11 should be sold on a result the tests below have not produced. The first six tests come from the v0.1 paper; the rest close the gaps this review found.

#	Test	Design	Success criterion	Criticality
1	Back-fill and distributions	Build instance history for Sensex-30, then NIFTY 500; review distributions of BI, D and walk-down shares before fixing thresholds	Stable, interpretable distributions; thresholds set from data	Critical
2	Label stability	How often does a descriptor change when one instance is added or removed?	Low flip rate at N_min and above	High
3	Parameter sensitivity	Vary tolerance, width floor, d, N_min, recency half-life	Labels robust across reasonable ranges	High
4	Extraction accuracy	Human double-review on a sample	At least 95% agreement on guided and actual values	Critical
5	Market pricing	Event study of post-guidance abnormal returns by descriptor (Brown and Warner 1985; MacKinlay 1997)	Significant and economically meaningful differences, or an honest null	High
6	Analyst fairness review	Practising analysts review each exclusion category	Exclusions accepted as fair	Medium
7	Predictive validity of the profile	Estimate profiles on past instances; test whether they predict where the next outcome lands relative to its guidance, and how often its band is revised	Out-of-sample lift over a naive prior	Critical
8	Incremental value	Compare against baselines: consensus surprise, SUE, last quarter's beat	Profile adds information beyond baselines	High

#	Test	Design	Success criterion	Criticality
9	Ablation of derived constructs	Each Layer 3 construct against a simple baseline (for example Timeliness vs cyclotomic phase)	A construct stays only if it adds measurable value	High
10	Point-in-time integrity	Audit timestamps and lineage for look-ahead	No look-ahead; reproducible from the evidence store	Critical
11	Factor orthogonality	Only if a scalar is kept: regress against standard factors with licensed data	Incremental alpha after controls, independently reproducible	Medium
12	q-GCI ground truth	Define labels for the claim ledger; measure inter-reviewer agreement	Reproducible labelling method	High

Parameter register. Every threshold is a proposal until tests 1 to 3 are done.

Parameter	Proposed value	Used in	Status
Point-guidance tolerance	1%	Converting point guidance to a band	Calibrate
Width floor	1% of midpoint (levels); 0.5 points (rates)	Floored half-width W0*	Calibrate
Bias thresholds	+20 and -20	Bias class	Calibrate on the NIFTY 500 distribution
Revision threshold d	0.5 of original half-width	Walk-down and walk-up	Calibrate
Path share threshold	30%	Path class	Calibrate
Revision Lift thresholds	+30 (walk-down signature); -30 (raise-and-beat)	Signatures	Calibrate
Minimum closed instances	6	Insufficient record	Test label stability

Parameter	Proposed value	Used in	Status
Dispersion threshold, D_max	Not set	Precise vs Variable	Open
Overshoot and persistence	OM at least 0.5; P8 at least 60%	Conservative-guidance signature	Calibrate; volatile sectors may mislabel
Recency half-life	8 quarters	No definition uses it	Resolve (Section 2.6)
Alpha and beta by metric	Asserted in the specification	Asymmetric loss	Estimate from price reactions (Layer 3)
Gamma and lambda	2.5 and 0.15	Phase penalty; EGIS coupling	Layer 3; likely retired
Phase threshold	0.35 radians, flat 15 point drop	Specification rule	Conflicts with the paper's smooth penalty
Regime adjustments	+0.25, -0.10, +0.05, +0.30	Harmonization	Unsourced
TCI weights w1 and w2	Not specified	Blend of quantitative and q-GCI	Open; do not ship blended

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4. Customers and Positioning

4.1 Target segments

Segment	Use case	Buying behavior	Priority
Quant / systematic funds	Factor input, event-risk signal	Data-driven; will test rigorously; sensitive to signal decay	High
Fundamental long-only / quality managers	Governance and management-integrity filter	Qualitative; value interpretability and case studies	High (Mumbai)
Risk and compliance teams	Pre-earnings gap-risk monitoring	Budget stability; need audit trails	Medium

Segment	Use case	Buying behavior	Priority
Sell-side / research	Differentiated research content	Smaller budgets	Low
Terminal/data platforms	Distribution and eventual acquirer	Long cycles	Strategic (later)

4.2 Positioning statement

"Point-in-time, filing-linked record of how reliably a company delivers on its guidance, with every number traced to a filing."

Avoid leading with "monopoly", "universal truth engine" or "zero hallucination". These read as marketing to buy-side evaluators.

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5. Go-to-Market Strategy (unfunded, prototype-first)

5.1 Principles

- Sell a **narrow wedge**, not the platform.
- Earn evidence before asking for money.
- Use Mumbai (home market, relationship access) and Singapore (regional capital hub) in sequence.
- Reinvest early revenue into integration and data quality, not marketing.

5.2 Phased plan

Phase	Timing (indicative)	Objective	Key actions	Exit criteria
0. Proof	Months 0–4	Validate the signal	Build prototype and backtest; publish methodology note; freeze v1 scoring	Backtest meets Section 3 criteria



Phase	Timing (indicative)	Objective	Key actions	Exit criteria
1. Wedge product	Months 3–6	Create a demonstrable tool	Pre-earnings gap-risk screener on citealpha.com for NIFTY 50/500 and STI; free tier with limited tickers	Working product, early usage signals
2. Design partners (Mumbai first)	Months 5–9	Real-world validation	3–5 design partners, 90-day structured pilots, written success criteria agreed upfront	At least 2 conversions to paid, or documented reasons why not
3. Paid pilots	Months 8–14	First revenue	Paid POCs, entry pricing, 1-page portfolio audits as the outreach hook	First recurring contracts
4. Singapore bridge	Months 10–18	Regional expansion	Case studies from Mumbai; engage Singapore quant and multi-strategy desks, family offices and asset managers	First Singapore paying logo
5. Distribution	Months 14–24	Scale	API/feeds, FDC3 integration, terminal marketplace submissions	Marketplace listing live

5.3 Mumbai targets

Cluster	Examples cited	Fit	Notes
Domestic AMCs	HDFC AMC, Kotak AMC, ICICI Prudential AMC	High for governance/quality use case	Large, slower procurement; start with analyst/PM-level champions

Cluster	Examples cited	Fit	Notes
Quality-focused managers	Abakkus, White Oak, ASK	High	Smaller, faster decisions; best early design-partner candidates
Broker-backed quant / research desks	Nuvama, Motilal Oswal, JM Financial	Medium-High	Test appetite for systematic signals
Global banks' India desks	Nomura, UBS, Macquarie, Daiwa, StanChart, HSBC	Medium	Often decisions made offshore; India desk is a user, not a buyer
Boutique quant AIFs / PMS	Various	High signal, low volume	Hard to identify; use network

Evaluative note. Real quant capacity in Mumbai is limited relative to Singapore. Lead with fundamental/quality managers, where interpretability and management-integrity framing resonate, and keep quant funds as a parallel track.

5.4 Singapore

- **Why:** concentration of regional multi-strategy and quant desks, sovereign and institutional allocators, and an active fintech support environment.
- **Targets named:** Millennium, Citadel, Point72, Two Sigma regional teams; GIC, Temasek; Schroders Asia, Fullerton.
- **Reality check:** Large pods and sovereign funds have long vendor-onboarding cycles, strict data-governance reviews, and rarely give public testimonials. Realistic entry is through smaller managers, family offices and individual analysts using the free tool, with large-fund relationships as a 12–24 month objective.
- **Support programmes:** Verify current MAS and industry grant/accelerator programmes directly; do not rely on the summary in the source conversation.

5.5 Pricing (starting hypothesis)

Tier	Description	Indicative price	Purpose
Free	Limited tickers, delayed scores	$0	Adoption, lead capture

Tier	Description	Indicative price	Purpose
Pilot / POC	3 months, defined universe	~$10k (cited)	Remove procurement friction
Professional	Screener + alerts + export	To be tested	Analyst/PM seats
Enterprise	API / flat files, multi-metric + q-GCI	To be tested	Core revenue

The discussion assumes $300k–$500k ACV. That is plausible only for mature, validated, API-integrated deployments. Early contracts are more likely to land in the **$20k–$100k** range. Plan on that until proven otherwise.

5.6 Design-partner structure

- Written success criteria agreed on day one (e.g., X% of gap-down events flagged, Y% false positives).
- Mutual NDA; clear data-use rights.
- Testimonial/case-study rights negotiated upfront, with anonymized fallback. Many funds will not be named, so plan for anonymized results.
- Weekly feedback cadence with a named champion.

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6. Valuation and Exit Analysis

6.1 What the source discussion claimed

Scenario	Multiple	Valuation at $75.2M ARR
Baseline private SaaS	4.5x–6.0x	$338M–$451M
High-growth leader	7.0x–9.0x	$526M–$677M
Tier-1 data infrastructure	10x–14x	$752M–$1.05B
Bloomberg (top case)	12x–15x	$902M–$1.13B

6.2 Evaluation

- **ARR basis is unsupported.** The source brief derives it from 50 to 80 clients at $300k to $500k ACV, which gives $15M to $40M, not $75.2M; reaching $75.2M at those prices needs roughly 150 to 250 clients. The later "$25M ARR in 18–24 months" estimate (55–

70 clients at $300–500k) is internally inconsistent with the earlier $75.2M path and with an unfunded start.

- **Multiples are optimistic.** The 4.5–6x range is a reasonable *base case*. 12–15x is an upside case requiring top-quartile growth, NRR above ~120–130%, high gross margins, and competitive tension, none of which exist today. Treat it as a stretch, not a plan.
- **"$2B at 15–20x"** is a speculative extrapolation. It should not appear in any investor or partner material at this stage.
- **Bloomberg as acquirer.** Bloomberg is privately held and historically builds more than it buys, so a competitive auction with Bloomberg as the anchor bidder is not a safe assumption. A more realistic path is partnership/marketplace distribution first, acquisition later.
- **Listing quirks:** S&P Global and IHS Markit are one company post-merger; the "Data Lake Division / Snowflake partners" tier is not a coherent acquirer category.

6.3 Planning scenarios (illustrative, to be replaced by real data)

Scenario	Assumption	Implication
Conservative	Niche tool, ~$1–3M ARR by year 3, mostly buy-side analysts	Lifestyle/bootstrapped business; possible acqui-hire or strategic licence
Base	$8–15M ARR by year 4–5 with API clients and one marketplace listing	Credible Series A/B candidate; 4–8x ARR
Upside	$25M+ ARR with strong NRR, multi-region, multiple distribution partners	Strategic interest, higher multiples

These are planning placeholders, not forecasts. Replace them with a bottom-up model: logos × ACV × conversion × sales cycle.

6.4 Potential acquirers/partners (later-stage)

Tier	Players	Strategic logic	Realism
Terminals/data	Bloomberg, LSEG, FactSet	Terminal stickiness; marketplace content	Partnership first
Index/risk	MSCI, S&P Global, Morningstar	New factor/diligence layer; index products	Plausible if orthogonal alpha is proven

Tier	Players	Strategic logic	Realism
Credit/analytics	Moody's	Link guidance misses to credit risk	Niche fit
PE	Vista, Thoma Bravo, Clearlake and peers	Cash-flow asset or platform roll-up	Needs scale and profitability

6.5 What drives value (in order of importance)

1. Demonstrated predictive edge (Section 3).
2. Net revenue retention and churn.
3. Data defensibility: proprietary, point-in-time, hard-to-replicate history.
4. Embedded workflow (API usage, terminal integration).
5. Distribution partnerships.

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7. Execution Roadmap and KPIs

Horizon	Milestone	Business KPI (not vanity)
0–4 months	Validated backtest, methodology note	IC, hit-rate, false-positive rate, coverage %
4–8 months	Screener live; 3–5 design partners signed	Active analyst users, weekly returning users, partner feedback score
8–14 months	First paid pilots	Pilot-to-paid conversion %, ACV, sales-cycle length
14–24 months	Singapore logo, API clients, first marketplace submission	ARR, logo count, NRR, gross margin, CAC payback
24+ months	Distribution partnerships	NRR >115–120%, churn <5% annually, ARR growth rate

Avoid reporting sign-ups, page views or follower counts as progress.

7.1 Team and resourcing

- **Technical lead (CTO):** data pipeline, point-in-time store, scoring engine, API.
- **Quant researcher:** backtest integrity and methodology. Independent review adds credibility.

- **NLP engineer:** q-GCI pipeline and evaluation.
- **Founder-led sales:** you in Mumbai initially; a Singapore-based advisor or partner for the second hub.
- **Advisors:** one senior buy-side PM and one compliance/data-licensing adviser.

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8. Risk Register

#	Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Criticality	Mitigation
1	Signal does not hold out-of-sample	Medium	Severe	**Critical**	Rigorous backtest first; kill/pivot criteria set in advance
2	Data licensing (transcripts, filings, price/estimates data)	High	High	**Critical**	Use public filings first; get legal review on commercial redistribution of derived scores
3	Regulatory classification (research/advice, MNPI handling) in India and Singapore	Medium	High	High	Position as data/analytics, not recommendations; take local legal advice on SEBI and MAS requirements
4	LLM reliability and bias in q-GCI	High	Medium-High	High	Source-linked outputs, human-in-loop sampling, evaluation set
5	Long enterprise sales cycles with no funding	High	High	High	Narrow wedge, low-friction POCs, founder-led sales
6	Over-engineered math with little marginal value	Medium	Medium	Medium	Ablation study; simplify if parity
7	Competitors (incumbent earnings-quality and sentiment vendors) replicate	Medium	Medium-High	High	Build proprietary history, speed on coverage, partner distribution
8	Founder over-confidence from unvalidated narratives	Medium	High	High	Independent review, evidence-gated milestones
9	Terminal marketplace gatekeeping and rev-share terms	Medium	Medium	Medium	Direct API sales in parallel
10	Single-region concentration	Low-Medium	Medium	Medium	Mumbai plus Singapore sequencing

Added after the document review

- **Methodological split (Critical):** two incompatible definitions of GCI circulate. Mitigation: decisions D1 and D7 and the conflicts register (Section 3.1).

- **Unverified performance claims used externally (Critical):** the +8.4% alpha and 3.8x gap-down figures cannot be reproduced from the documents. Quarantine them (D4) until tests 7, 8 and 10 in Section 3.3 are done.
- **Imputing intent to named listed companies (High):** motive words such as "sandbagging" and "deceiving" invite legal and reputational challenge. Use neutral labels (D2) and keep sensitivity views and exclusions visible.
- **Terminal feasibility and certification cost (High):** go-live dates, SOC 2 Type II and uptime commitments rest on partner programmes and operating history outside the team's control. Stage them (Section 12.3).
- **Unverified references (Medium):** the v0.1 paper and this document both cite literature from memory. Verify before external release.

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9. Corrections to Carry Forward from the Gemini Discussion

Statement in the source	Status	Action
"$75.2M ARR" projection	The brief's own inputs give $15M to $40M	Rebuild as a bottom-up model before reuse
"$1B+ unicorn at $75.2M ARR"	Upside case, not base	Present multiples as ranges with explicit conditions
"$2B valuation at 15–20x ARR"	Speculative	Remove from external material
"Zero-hallucination"	Not defensible for LLM-based extraction	Replace with "source-linked, auditable"
"No equity on earth is left un-scorable"	Overstated	State actual coverage with percentages
"Master stroke / true visionary"	Opinion, not evidence	Disregard; evidence comes from validation
55–70 clients at $300–500k ACV in 18–24 months	Highly aggressive for an unfunded start	Plan on slower ramp and lower early ACV
"Free access in exchange for signed testimonial"	Often unrealistic with large funds	Plan for anonymized case studies
Bloomberg bidding war	Unlikely default	Pursue partnership first
Association with named funds (Citadel, Two Sigma etc.) as customers	Targets, not relationships	Do not imply endorsement or usage

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10. Next 90 Days: Action Plan

#	Action	Owner	Output	Priority
1	Lock the point-in-time dataset and universe (NIFTY 500 first, then STI)	CTO / quant	Clean, timestamped dataset	Critical
2	Run baseline vs GCI backtest with out-of-sample split	Quant	Evidence report	Critical

#	Action	Owner	Output	Priority
3	Run ablation on loss curves and decay models	Quant	Keep/drop decisions	High
4	Legal review: data licensing and regulatory positioning (India, Singapore)	Founder + counsel	Written guidance	High
5	Build the screener MVP on citealpha.com	CTO	Live tool	High
6	Draft design-partner term sheet and success criteria	Founder	One-pager and template	High
7	Shortlist 15 Mumbai names; secure 5 warm introductions	Founder	Outreach list	High
8	Build the bottom-up revenue model	Founder	Spreadsheet with scenarios	Medium
9	Define q-GCI ground-truth labeling method	NLP / quant	Methodology note	Medium
10	Identify Singapore advisor/partner	Founder	Shortlist	Medium

Added after the document review

1. Decide D1 to D7 in Section 1.3 with the document owners (Critical).
2. Confirm whether the v3.40 backtest exists; if so, document data, code and universe, otherwise retire the figures (Critical).
3. Encode the two golden test cases and resolve the open design questions in Section 2.6 (High).
4. Complete the landscape check in Section 2.4 with cited vendor documentation (High).
5. Specify the single-score aggregation or drop it, and define the divergence flag and the Timeliness measure as the replacements for EGIS and the cyclotomic phase (Medium).

Decision gate at day 90: proceed to design partners only if the backtest shows a statistically and economically meaningful edge. If not, narrow to the sub-signal that works (for example margin guidance only) before spending on outreach.

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11. Summary of Positioning

- **Product:** A filing-linked behavioural record of guidance delivery (Bias, Dispersion, Path), with derived scores and q-GCI as separate, opt-in layers.
- **Wedge:** Pre-earnings gap-risk screener, free for analysts, paid for institutions.
- **Market sequence:** Mumbai fundamental/quality managers first, then Singapore regional desks, then terminal marketplaces.
- **Exit logic:** Value comes from proven signal, retention, and distribution. Acquirer interest follows evidence; it cannot be engineered ahead of it.
- **Operating rule:** Every claim in a sales or investor document should be backed by a number, a test, or a named source.

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12. Product, Data and Terminal Integration Requirements

The first product is the evidence store with a direct web, API and flat-file surface; terminal listings come after paid traction. This section condenses the Terminal Onboarding Specification, the Comprehensive Specification and the v0.1 audit-trail rules into one build reference.

12.1 Evidence record schema (Layer 0)

Field	Content
Guidance source	Filing, date, page and paragraph of the original guidance
Revisions	Each revised range with its filing and date
Actual	First reported actual with filing and date; restated value shown alongside
Extraction	Method and verification status (machine-extracted, human-reviewed or corrected), plus reviewer
Corrections	Versioned; never overwritten
Exclusions	Excluded instances stay visible with the reason
Integrity	SHA-256 checksum of each source document; Event_Timestamp and Filing_Timestamp so no score pre-dates public availability

12.2 Requirements by surface

Surface	Requirement in the specifications	Readiness note	Stage
Own web app, REST API, Parquet files	JSON endpoints and S3 Parquet; the specification proposes one endpoint per metric (for example /api/v1/gci/revenue)	Prefer a resource model: instance, profile, evidence record	1
FDC3 desktop interoperability	Publish fdc3.instrument contexts so a ticker change in one window updates the widget (FINOS standard)	Buildable without a partner; prototype early	1 to 2
Bloomberg	HTML5 container via the App Portal; PORT custom factors; B-PIPE feeds; entitlement integration	Mnemonic, programme terms and factor ingestion are Bloomberg's to set; verify	3
FactSet	Open API and Workstation integration; REST services populating grids in under 150 ms	Depends on FactSet's partner programme	3
LSEG Workspace	App Studio sandboxed HTML5 container; European qualitative outlooks under ESMA/MAR	Depends on LSEG's partner programme	3
Security	SOC 2 Type II, ISO 27001, AES-256 at rest, TLS 1.3 in transit	Controls first; attestation timing set by the first enterprise procurement, since Type II needs operating history	2 to 3
Availability	99.99% uptime, multi-region failover, sub-100 ms latency	Tier the targets by stage; commit to an SLA only when a contract requires it	3

12.3 Rollout in the specifications vs this document

Specified phase	Specified content	Assessment
Phase 1, months 1 to 3	Mumbai and Singapore sandbox on NIFTY 500 and STI; 3 design partners (HDFC, Kotak, an APAC quant fund)	Consistent with India first, but tests 1, 4 and 7 in Section 3.3 should precede partner trials
Phase 2, months 4 to 6	FactSet and LSEG beta on S&P 500 and Stoxx Europe 600	Premature: widens coverage to the US and Europe before India is validated, and depends on partner programmes
Phase 3, months 7 to 12	Bloomberg go-live on global equities; B-PIPE certification; SOC 2 Type II; full App Portal listing	Timelines are not in the team's control; Type II needs operating history

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13. Glossary and Naming Decisions

One name per object. Terms 1 to 15 come from the v0.1 paper; the last four are proposals for the owners to confirm (decision D7).

#	Term	Definition
1	Instance	One company, one metric, one period
2	Original guidance	The first guidance issued for the period, locked
3	Band class	Above, Within or Below the original band in the favourable direction
4	s*	Band-normalized, favourable-signed surprise
5	Bias Index (BI)	100 x (share Above - share Below)
6	Overshoot (O), OM	Distance beyond the favourable band edge in original half-widths; median over Above instances
7	P8	Share of the latest 8 closed instances that are Above band
8	Dispersion (D)	Robust standard deviation of s*
9	Walk-down, walk-up	Unfavourable or favourable revision of guidance before results

#	Term	Definition
10	Path	Class describing revision behaviour: Stable, Walk-down-prone, Walk-up-prone, Mixed
11	Revision Lift (RL)	BI against final guidance minus BI against original guidance
12	Walk-down signature	Walk-down-prone with Revision Lift at least +30
13	Conservative-guidance signature	Under-promising, OM at least 0.5 and P8 at least 60%; often called sandbagging, which implies intent and is not used in product copy
14	Participation	Withdrawn count and continuity (periods guided over periods expected)
15	Insufficient record	Fewer than N_min closed instances
16	Guidance Profile (proposed)	The Layer 2 output: Bias class, Dispersion class, Path class, signatures and Revision Lift
17	GCI (proposed)	The name of the framework and brand; "GCI score" reserved for an optional scalar, once fully specified
18	Narrative signals (proposed)	Replaces q-GCI for the tone and hedging module; the claim ledger keeps the q-GCI name
19	EGIS and TCI	Retire unless separately specified

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14. References (to Verify)

The first five are cited in the v0.1 paper, which states they were written from memory. The last four are added in this document, also from memory. Verify every one before external use.

Reference	Used for
Brown, S. and Warner, J. (1985). Using daily stock returns: the case of event studies. Journal of Financial Economics	Event-study method (test 5)
MacKinlay, A.C. (1997). Event studies in economics and finance. Journal of Economic Literature	Event-study method (test 5)

Reference	Used for
Matsumoto, D. (2002). Management's incentives to avoid negative earnings surprises. The Accounting Review	Incentive to avoid negative surprises
Richardson, S., Teoh, S.H. and Wysocki, P. (2004). The walk-down to beatable analyst forecasts. Contemporary Accounting Research	Walk-down behaviour in analyst forecasts
Rogers, J. and Stocken, P. (2005). Credibility of management forecasts. The Accounting Review	Credibility of management forecasts
Skinner, D. and Sloan, R. (2002). Earnings surprises, growth expectations, and stock returns. Review of Accounting Studies	Asymmetric price response to surprises
Hirst, D.E., Koonce, L. and Venkataraman, S. (2008). Management earnings forecasts: a review and framework. Accounting Horizons	Literature review for the landscape check
Chen, S., Matsumoto, D. and Rajgopal, S. (2011). Is silence golden? Journal of Accounting and Economics	Firms that stop guiding (participation)
Loughran, T. and McDonald, B. (2011). When is a liability not a liability? Textual analysis, dictionaries, and 10-Ks. Journal of Finance	Finance-specific lexicon baseline for tone signals